

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6
♥ 6
♦ K 8 5 4 2
♣ Q 9 3

♠ A K 5 4

♥ A 3 2

♦ Q J 10

♣ J 7 6



♠ 9 8 3 2
♥ 10 4
♦ 9 7 6 3
♣ K 10 5

♠ 7

♥ K Q J 9 8 7 5

♦ A

♣ A 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 3

It can't do any good to ruff your fourth ♣ in dummy because you would have to lose two before that could happen. Of course one of your ♣s can be discarded on dummy's ♠K but what about the other two?

Suppose you win the ♠ and unblock the ♦A. Play ♥K, then to dummy's ♥A. Take one ♣ discard on the ♠K, then play the ♦Q and discard a second ♣.

It won't work. You would establish the ♦ for your last discard but you have no entry to it.

This will work. At trick 2 discard the ♦A on dummy's ♠K. Play the ♦Q and discard a ♣ when East doesn't cover. West will take the ♦K and attack ♣s but you are in control now. You win your ♣A, pull trumps, ending in dummy, and discard the remaining 2 ♣ losers on dummy's ♦J 10.

This is called a Jettison play. You sacrifice your ♦A to unblock the suit for dummy's ♦Q J 10.

If East held the ♦K the play would be slightly different; you would have to ruff when he covered. But the result would be the same.

Did you notice that you started with 3 ♣ losers and no ♦ loser, but you ended up losing 1 ♦ and no ♣s?

There would be nothing wrong with a transfer bid here, but probably no advantage either. What you really want to know is how many Aces partner has. So you ask him with a Gerber 4♣ bid.

Partner says 4♠ (2 Aces),

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Partner says 4♠ (2 Aces),

Looking at three possible ♣ losers you bid 6♥.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. The first trick is easy; you win with dummy's ♠A.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J
 ♥ K Q 3
 ♦ Q J 10 9 6 5
 ♣ 7 6

♠ 8 4 3

♥ 9 5

♦ A 7 3

♣ K Q 9 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 7 6 5

♥ J 10 6 2

♦ 8

♣ A 8 4 2

♠ A K 9 2

♥ A 8 7 4

♦ K 4 2

♣ J 10

West	North	East	South
			1NT
2♦	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

First decide about what to do at trick #1. If you hold up and West plays another ♦, no harm will be done. But probably no good will be done either because West is likely to have 6 ♦s, leaving East with just a singleton anyway. But what if West pockets the one ♦ trick and switches to ♥s, a suit where you only have one stopper? Since that might turn out badly, you should **NOT** hold up.

As to which hand to win it in, that's easy. You need to preserve any dummy entries that you can so you win the first trick with your ♦K.

Now you establish some ♣ winners. You play the ♣J and both defenders play low.

You have to assume that defenders good enough to hold up their ♣A at the first opportunity will be good enough to do it on the second play also. But you can thwart them by next playing your ♣10 and overtaking with dummy's ♣Q. Even if they do hold up again you can continue with another ♣ from dummy to establish the suit while you still have the ♦A for an entry.

If you fail to overtake the second ♣ East will hold up the ♣A again.

Then you will lose all those ♣ tricks in dummy.

Partner's 2NT is the lebensohl convention. He requests that you bid 3♣ as a relay, which you do. Partner now bids 3NT.

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When partner bids 3NT AFTER the lebensohl 2NT, he is suggesting you play there, and he guarantees a stopper in their suit. You are happy to pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♦Q. West attacks in ♦s and you must make an immediate choice. Hold up, win in dummy, or win in your hand.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 5